

St. Alexis of Wilkes-Barre Orthodox Church

A Mission of the Orthodox Church in America

2323 N State St, Unit 112, Bunnell, FL 32110

Sunday Divine Liturgy 9:30 AM

Confessions heard Saturday after Great Vespers or by appointment

SUNDAY, OCTOBER 11

TONE 2

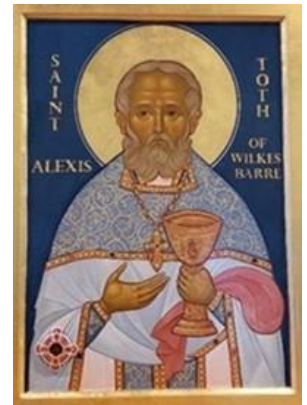
19th Sunday after Pentecost (3rd of Luke)

Commemoration of the Holy Fathers of the 7th Ecumenical Council



“The Orthodox Christian Church is evangelical, but not Protestant. It is orthodox, but not Jewish. It is catholic, but not Roman. It is not denominational, it is pre-denominational. It has believed, taught, preserved, defended, and died for the Faith of the Apostles since the Day of Pentecost nearly 2,000 years ago.”

– *Our Life in Christ*



Welcome to our Guests!

Thank you for coming to pray with us. You will find a blue guest information card next to the weekly bulletin with today's hymns on the table where you entered. Please fill out the card and give it to a greeter or to our priest, Fr David, who looks forward to meeting you! You are also invited to *Coffee Fellowship* in the parish hall following the Liturgy this morning.

According to ancient Christian practice, Holy Communion (Eucharist) is served to members of the Orthodox Church who have made preparation through prayer, fasting, and recent confession, and who are at peace with their neighbor. If you are not a member of the Orthodox Church, you may be offered blessed bread (*antidoron*) by others in respect and love.

Announcements:

Many Years to the Aravena family (along with their sponsors, godparents, and extended family) on the occasion of their reception into the Orthodox Church by baptism and chrismation!

Today Vinnie Vincent and Amy Maria offer their newly born daughter Isabel Elizabeth back to the Lord through the arms of Christ's holy Church in baptism and also unite themselves to Christ and His Body, the Church, through confession and chrismation. As noted in past bulletins, the service begins with prayers of exorcism, drawing a line in the sand, so to speak, forbidding the evil one from destroying these precious ones. Water is consecrated to be life-giving and not death-bearing, and the child is anointed with oil, as an athlete before a contest. Buried in water and rising with Christ, life truly begins. The child and her parents will then be anointed with holy Chrism, affirming "The seal of the gift of the Holy Spirit," to which we respond, "Sealed!" They will each make an offering to the Lord through tithing and then Isabel Elizabeth will be formally "churched," introduced in her new holy house, the Church building. When the parents finally receive her back into their own arms, they are holy stewards, for their child belongs to the Lord. All present in this service are committing to pray for this family all the days of their lives!

Today we celebrate Annual Church Musician Sunday highlighting the essential role of liturgical music in Orthodox Christian worship and the important role of church musicians in the life of the Church. We will joyfully recognize those who serve in the various roles involved in Church music: choir directors, singers, chanters, readers, composers, arrangers, and bellringers, through a public acknowledgment following the Divine Liturgy. Additionally, parishioners and parish leaders are strongly encouraged by our Holy Synod to consider the many essential responsibilities of those who lead the musical responses during the Divine services including the offering of appropriate remuneration for choir directors. This is one reason the Parish Council of St. Alexis has included a stipend for the Choir Director in our annual budget. Your tithes and offerings support this ministry.

SAVE THE DATE: Annual Parish Meeting SUNDAY NOVEMBER 1
(Agenda & 2027 Budget draft available)

Nativity Decorating Team Meeting Sunday October 25 following Coffee Fellowship Hour in Parish Hall. For any and all interested in brainstorming ideas for Christmas, we will meet Sunday October 25 to discuss how to decorate our new space for the Feast of the Nativity of Christ. If you are interested but unable to stay for the meeting, you may text/email your ideas and suggestions by **10/24** to **Carol Buriak** ([540-526-7589](tel:540-526-7589) or c_buriak@yahoo.com). Thanks in advance to all!

Be sure to check the church calendar, aka *Life in our Church*, on the last page of the bulletin! There are numerous upcoming baptisms and chrismations, so be sure to mark your calendars and plan to be present to bear witness as our new brothers and sisters are joined to the Body of Christ through these holy Mysteries and to welcome them to our St. Alexis parish family!

Orthodox Conversations 2.0! **Orthodox Conversations** is taking a new turn, rotating each week with different age groups. This Sunday Fr David plans to share some ***Awesome Anecdotes with Middle and High School students and young adults*** illustrating our weekly scripture readings. We will gather in the nave about 30 minutes after Coffee Fellowship begins.

Member-Missionary Map of the World

The world map hanging in the hallway across from the kitchen has small **blue**-headed pins on the side. ***Members are invited to place a blue pin where they were born.*** All blue pins remain anonymous, helping us rejoice in the countries and cultures represented in our local parish and how the Body of Christ brings us together. **Green** pins will indicate where our missionaries serve and will be connected to their pictures.

Want to schedule time during the week with Fr David for confession or pastoral counsel? There's an app for that...or at least a link! [**Schedule Time with Fr David**](#) Please note that any meeting scheduled with him will be *at the church* unless otherwise requested.

See below for full link information if you only have a hard copy of this bulletin:

<https://bookings.cloud.microsoft/book/ScheduletimewithFrDavidPriestatStAlexisMission@synergylife.coach/?ismsaljsauthenabled>

Encouraging ACH donations at St. Alexis for Tithes and Offerings and the Building Fund

We encourage online donors to choose **ACH** rather than credit card transactions. Our parish is charged a 2.2% transaction fee for each credit card donation. In contrast, we are charged only \$.25 for each ACH donation. To donate via ACH, register with **Church Connect**, a one-time, quick, secure set up:

Church Connect - Our St Alexis Orthodox Church App

- Scan the **QR code** with your smart phone to create your account
- You may also go directly to the link at: stalexisoca.org/give
- If you need help setting up your account, see Mka Rozanne or Mike Ruddy
- Note that payments to the Book Store are NOT payable on-line.



NEW ONGOING Opportunities for Love and Ministry in our Parish:

- ❖ **Church Cleaning Time happens every Wednesday 3:30-5:30pm (Vespers begins at 6pm).** Nelya Lashkul is a steward of this ministry. Ask her how you can help or contact the church office.
- ❖ **We are looking for volunteers for church projects and assistance in the office.** Come by the church office during office hours and ask, "How can I help?"
- ❖ **Child Care:** Interested in helping our catechumens in providing supervision for their children during *Orthodox Conversations* each Sunday after Coffee Fellowship Hour and catechism each Wednesday 6:30-7:30pm? This is a special ministry requiring at least two qualified adults each Wednesday evening. An honorarium may be available if needed for this ministry. See Fr David or Mka Rozanne to learn more.
 - NOTE: According to OCA policies, anyone who works with children in the parish must submit to a background check and complete a briefing process. There must be two adults caring for children at all times unless the children are with a parent or relative.
- ❖ **Are you interested in evangelism and the apostolic ministry of the Church (missionaries and their work)?** OCMC is looking for representative for each parish to assist the priest in promoting and sharing how we are fulfilling the Great Commission of our Lord to "go make disciples of all nations" in Jerusalem (our own county), Judea (our state), Samaria (the state of GA-- just kidding!), AND to the ends of the earth. See Fr David if you are interested in partnering with him to better equip our members to be the Lord's disciples. If you are not called to "go" as a missionary, then your calling is to enable others to go! This relates to the central purpose of St. Alexis Orthodox Mission.

Prayer Lists – Pray for each other daily:

The Departed:

- The Priest Slava
- The newly departed Stefan Stanescu
- Mka Catherine (Sissy) Yerger
- Geoff Nicholas Brueggen
- Nina Myasnikova
- Wesley Theophan Sheldahl
- Sandra Chan Ajram
- Jessica Joanna Wright
- Henry Poleschuk
- The unborn
- Victims of accidents, hostilities, and natural disasters around the world

All whom we carry in our hearts, including:

- Fr Aleksandr Yu Shi, Fr. Kung Ming Cheung, Fr. Denis
- Fr Patrick, Mka Lauren, James, Walter, Henry, Kathryn, Ethan, Marissa & the child she carries, Andrew
- The Harris, Drennan, Hargrave, & Kingery clergy families
- Archimandrite Sergius
- OCMC missionaries and staff including the Hoppes, Doelmans, Brandows, MacDonalds, & Hannah Valentine

- Iconographers Elena & Anya and wood craftsmen who will build the sanctuary and iconostasis
- Ilya, Moses, Elena, Naomi, Danica, Stela, Gordana, Larry, Gabriel, Elizabeth, David, Lisa, Karla Anna
- Emilia and the child she carries
- Joanna and the child she carries
- The newly illumined Vinnie *Vincent*, Amy *Maria*, Isabelle *Elizabeth* and their families and sponsors
- The newly illumined Noelle *Mary* and her family and godparents
- Catechumens Chris, Lesly, Gianna, Marco, Samuel, Maryam, Gillian, Tyler
- All members of our community traveling or on the bed of sickness
- All who are homeless, unemployed, or under-employed in our community
- All of our guests and inquirers seeking God through the Orthodox Church

Hymns for this Sunday: *Please sing along with the choir – and all week long!*

Tone 2 Troparion (Resurrection)

When Thou didst descend to death, O Life immortal,
 Thou didst slay hell with the splendor of Thy Godhead.
 And when from the depths Thou didst raise the dead,
 all the powers of heaven cried out://
 “O Giver of life, Christ our God, glory to Thee!”

Tone 8 Troparion (Fathers)

Thou art most glorious, O Christ our God,
 Who hast established the Holy Fathers as lights on the earth.
 Through them Thou hast guided us to the True Faith.//
 O greatly compassionate One, glory to Thee!

Tone 2 Kontakion (Resurrection)

Hell became afraid, O almighty Savior,
 seeing the miracle of Thy Resurrection from the tomb!
 The dead arose! Creation, with Adam, beheld this and rejoiced with Thee,//
 and the world, my Savior, praises Thee forever.

Tone 6 Kontakion (Fathers)

The Son Who shone forth from the Father
 was ineffably born, two-fold in nature, of a woman.
 Having beheld Him, we do not deny the image of His form,
 but depict it piously and revere it faithfully.
 Thus, keeping the True Faith,//
 the Church venerates the icon of Christ Incarnate.

Scripture Readings for this Sunday:

Epistle: 2 Corinthians 11:31-12:9 & Romans 6:3-11
Gospel: Luke 7:11-16 & Matthew 28:16-20

His Grace, The Right Rev. GERASIM, Bishop of Ft. Worth, *Locum Tenens* of the Diocese of the South

Archpriest David C. Rucker ♦ 904-599-5812 ♦ priest@stalexisoca.org

Parish Council President James Humphries ♦ 904-540-2476

Helen Ireland, Treasurer, George Andrews, Jr., Secretary and Members-at-Large: Charles Fausey, Ali Marie Phipps, Karla Anna Ayer

Life in our Church

Saturday, Oct 10	Choir Rehearsal <i>(in the nave)</i> Memorial Prayers <i>(Jessica Joanna Wright)</i> Great Vespers <i>(Confessions following)</i>	3:30 PM 4:45 PM 5:00 PM
Sunday, Oct 11	Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom <i>Fathers of the 7th Ecumenical Council</i> Baptism/Chrismations <i>(the Aravena family)</i> <i>Church Musicians Recognition</i> <i>Coffee Fellowship Hour</i> Awesome Anecdotes with Fr David <i>(for Middle & High School students & young adults)</i>	9:30 AM ~12:30 PM
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Wednesday, Oct 14	Parish Council Meeting Church Cleaning Vespers <i>(Catechism following)</i>	3:30 PM 3:30 PM 6:00 PM
Saturday, Oct 17	Choir Rehearsal <i>(in the nave)</i> Great Vespers <i>(Confessions following)</i>	3:30 PM 5:00 PM
Sunday, Oct 18	Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom <i>Coffee Fellowship Hour</i> Open Discussion/Q&A <i>in nave</i> <i>in preparation for Annual Meeting November 1</i> <i>(Agenda & 2027 Budget draft available)</i>	9:30 AM 12 -12:30 PM
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Wednesday, Oct 21	Church Cleaning Vespers <i>(Catechism following)</i>	3:30 PM 6:00 PM
Saturday, Oct 24	Choir Rehearsal <i>(in the nave)</i> Great Vespers <i>(Confessions following)</i>	3:30 PM 5:00 PM
Sunday, Oct 25	Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom Baptism <i>(Maryam Lashkul)</i> & Chrismation <i>(Gillian Taylor)</i> <i>Coffee Fellowship Hour</i> Nativity Decorating Committee <i>(in Parish Hall)</i> Open Discussion/Q&A <i>in nave</i> <i>in preparation for Annual Meeting November 1</i> <i>(Agenda & 2027 Budget draft available)</i>	9:30 AM ~12:30 PM ~12:30 PM
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<i>Oct 27-30 Thriving in Ministry Facilitators Retreat (Ruckers)</i>		
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Wednesday, Oct 28	Church Cleaning Prayers <i>(Catechism following)</i>	3:30 PM 6:00 PM
Saturday, Oct 31	Choir Rehearsal <i>(in the nave)</i> Great Vespers <i>(Confessions following)</i>	3:30 PM 5:00 PM
Don't Forget: Turn Clocks Back One Hour Saturday Night!		
Sunday, Nov 1	Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom <u>Abbreviated</u> <i>Coffee Fellowship Hour (NO POTLUCK)</i> Annual Parish Meeting	9:30 AM ~12:00 PM